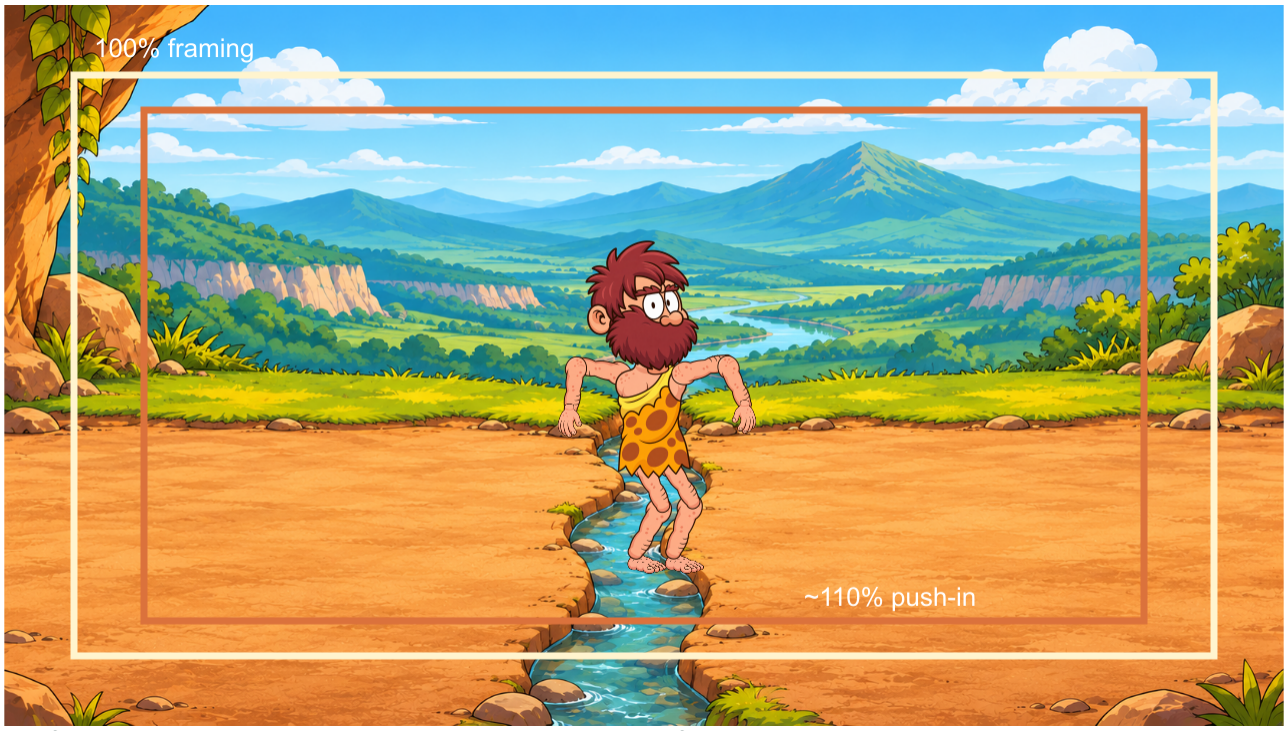
WORKBOOK 07 / 08 · MULTIMEDIA 12

Use effects and camera to tell the story

Raw-shape tweening, splash timing, sound hierarchy and a motivated push-in



Camera-framing study: a restrained push-in must retain essential story information.

Build: Add one controlled effect and one justified camera move that support the Caveman's action.

Keep: Splash test + camera comparison + mixed scene preview

Shared story: A Caveman wants a third counting stone. A stream stands in his way. He studies it, commits to a jump, retrieves the stone and returns to count his collection with enormous pride.

Document: ActionScript 3.0 · 1280 × 720 · 24 fps · three main Scenes · Graphic symbols for scrubbable character actions

Two provisional 70-minute sessions. Use the HTML guide for read-aloud, switchable supports, recovery files and narrated explanation. This print version includes the essential support prompts.

Continue the same film

Create the project in Workbook 1. For every later workbook, open the selected previous production FLA and Save As a new numbered checkpoint, preserving all three Scenes and the complete Library. Keep repair/director copies separate; return to the chosen production version.

Understand before you animate

Effects and camera should direct attention toward the story event. A visible effect is successful only if its timing and meaning fit the action.

Classic tweens transform symbol instances. Shape tweens interpolate raw vector shapes. Imported bitmap art and Graphic instances are not raw shapes. The camera belongs to the main Scene timeline for this workflow, not inside the character symbol. Sound and camera settings must be checked in the installed document type and final export.

Today’s checklist

1. Predict the result. 2. Build four stages. 3. Check in playback. 4. Refine, diagnose and direct. 5. Save and reopen.

Independent director condition

Make the landing feel heavier using pose, effect and sound. Keep the same jump distance and avoid camera shake as a substitute for impact.

What you will defend

Identify the frame that causes the splash/sound, and explain what the camera move helps the viewer notice.

Support choices

Use the step summaries, glossary, numbered checklist, different-object examples, explanation frames and optional stretch. Open the companion HTML for browser read-aloud and the narrated six-slide explanation. Supports change access to the task; the success criteria remain the same.

Your planning notes

01 · Identify the event before making the effect

SELECT: Crossing first-contact frame and water area.

TOOLS / ROUTE: Timeline review; Notes guide layer.

1. Mark the landing contact and the moment any splash should begin. If the feet land on dry bank, use a small dust effect instead of unexplained water from the feet.

2. Choose one effect: a water droplet disturbed near the stream or a bank dust puff. State what causes it.

3. Keep the first test in a separate short Graphic so the effect can be inspected without the whole film.

WHY · An effect needs a cause and location; random splashes weaken physical logic.

CHECK / SUMMARY · You can name the event and show the effect's origin beside the correct contact point.

FIX · If the effect starts before its cause, move the first visible key later. If there is no water contact, choose dust or omit the splash.

GLOSSARY · cause and effect: An event producing a visible or audible response.

DIFFERENT-OBJECT EXAMPLE · A foot on a dry path raises dust; a stone entering water creates a splash.

STRETCH · Use a tiny falling pebble as the visible cause of a water effect.

Your checkpoint: predict → observe → revise

Prediction: _____

Observed result / frame: _____

Revision or next check: _____

02 · Build a genuine raw-shape tween

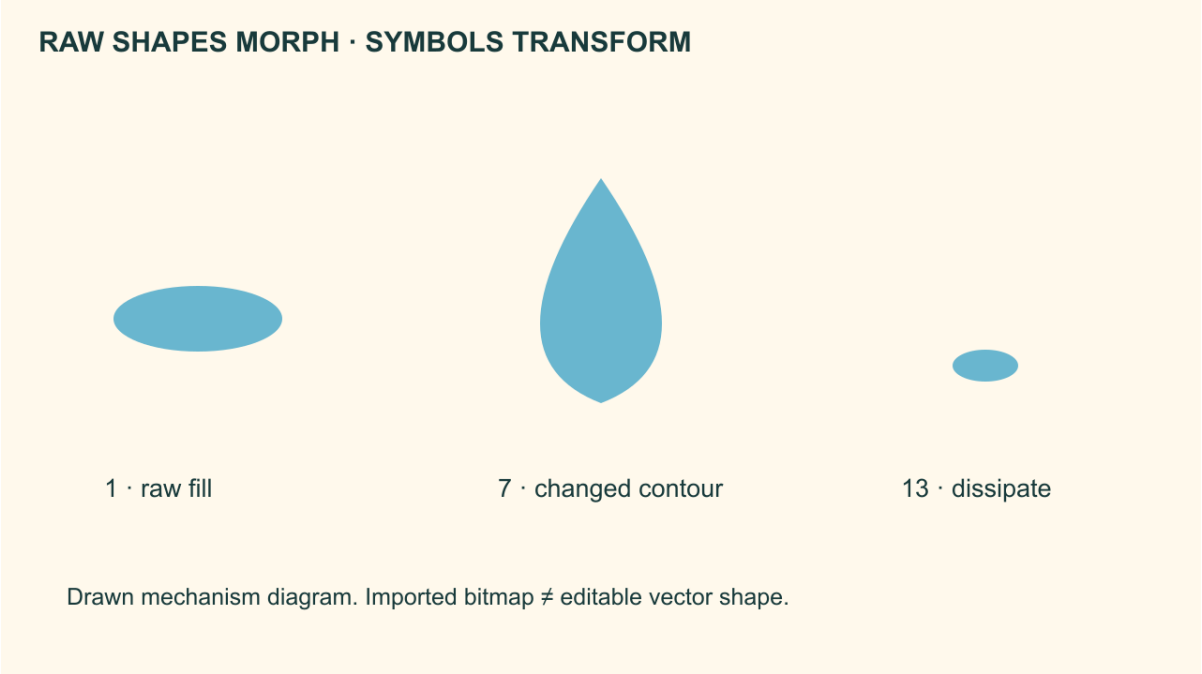
SELECT: A new Splash_Test or Dust_Test Graphic; raw drawn vector fill.

TOOLS / ROUTE: Oval/Brush tool; Insert Keyframe; right-click span → Create Shape Tween.

1. Draw a simple filled droplet or puff at frame 1 with no symbol wrapper. At frame 7 create a new key and change the raw vector shape; at 13 create a smaller dissipating shape.

2. Apply Shape Tween to the suitable spans. Scrub to check the intermediate contours. At frame 14 insert a BLANK keyframe on every visible effect layer; ordinary F5 frames would keep the last puff visible.

3. Keep the test simple: one coherent shape per layer. If you need multiple droplets, use separate layers or designed frame-by-frame drawings.



Raw-vector contour changes illustrate a shape tween; placed bitmap artwork requires a different method.

WHY · This makes the distinction between transforming a symbol and changing a raw shape visible.

CHECK / SUMMARY · The selected span is a shape tween and intermediate frames change the contour, not merely the object scale.

FIX · If the span fails, check that contents are raw vector shapes. Breaking apart a bitmap does not turn it into clean editable vector artwork.

GLOSSARY · shape tween: Interpolation between raw vector shapes.; raw shape: Editable vector fill/stroke artwork that is not a symbol instance.

DIFFERENT-OBJECT EXAMPLE · A drawn blob can morph into a teardrop; a placed photo cannot become a clean vector droplet simply by selecting Shape Tween.

STRETCH · Compare a shape-tween droplet with a frame-by-frame splash and justify the clearer one.

03 · Place the effect at its real cause

SELECT: Main Scene effect layer above the appropriate ground/water area.

TOOLS / ROUTE: Library → place effect Graphic; Play Once or timeline-limited exposure.

1. Place the effect at the marked event frame. Use Play Once for the Graphic if available and suitable, or limit its main-timeline exposure so it does not repeat.

2. Scale it to support the contact, keeping the Caveman's feet and important pose readable.

3. Scrub before, during and after contact. Confirm it is absent before the cause and clears before it distracts from retrieval.

WHY · A well-timed small effect can clarify impact more effectively than a large continuous overlay.

CHECK / SUMMARY · One caused effect appears once and clears in time for the next story beat.

FIX · If it repeats, check Graphic playback mode and parent exposure. If the contact is hidden, reduce size or move the effect behind the foot.

GLOSSARY · exposure: The frames over which artwork remains visible.

DIFFERENT-OBJECT EXAMPLE · A camera flash should appear briefly at the shutter event, not loop through the whole scene.

STRETCH · Let two small effect elements finish at different times for controlled overlap.

Your checkpoint: predict → observe → revise

Prediction: _____

Observed result / frame: _____

Revision or next check: _____

04 · Add a motivated main-Scene camera move

SELECT: Me_clever main Scene; Camera tool; no nested character edit.

TOOLS / ROUTE: Camera tool → camera layer → keys and zoom controls.

1. Create a Camera layer with the Camera tool on the main Scene. Frame the three counting stones and the hand before adding movement.

2. Use a neutral camera key near the final proud phrase and a later key with a restrained push from 100 to about 110 percent. Choose an appropriate classic camera span as supported by your installed Animate version.

3. Review the full count. Keep fingers, mouth and stones within the visible camera area. The old 80–105 camera test was only a control check, not a cue plan for your new recording.

WHY · The push-in emphasizes the Caveman’s pride after the story goal is achieved.

CHECK / SUMMARY · The camera moves only when it has a purpose, and essential information remains visible throughout.

FIX · If the whole character grows but the background does not, you probably scaled the character instead of the camera. If the camera controls differ, use the static framing fallback and record the gap.

GLOSSARY · push-in: A camera move that makes the subject occupy more of the frame.; camera framing: The portion of the scene shown to the audience.

DIFFERENT-OBJECT EXAMPLE · A slow move toward a detective’s realization can focus attention on the change in thought.

STRETCH · Compare static and moving versions with a viewer and justify your selection.

05 · Build a simple sound hierarchy

SELECT: Voice and effects on separate named audio layers.

TOOLS / ROUTE: Frame sound properties; timeline preview; final movie playback.

1. Keep voice clearly intelligible. Add only approved or self-made effects for the jump/landing and optional stone contact.

2. Align impact sound with the visible contact event, allowing a deliberate stylistic offset only if you can justify it. Prevent effects from masking “one, two, three.”

3. Listen through speakers or headphones at a comfortable level and check the entire film, including Scene transitions.

WHY · Sound can establish weight and focus, but the story depends on understanding the performance.

CHECK / SUMMARY · Speech remains clear and there are no cut-off effects, unexplained repeated sounds or accidental silence at transitions.

FIX · If a sound repeats unexpectedly, inspect its Sync setting and exposure. If mixing controls are insufficient, adjust the source effect in an approved audio editor and reimport.

GLOSSARY · sound hierarchy: Prioritizing important audio, such as voice, over supporting effects.; synchronization: Aligning related picture and sound events.

DIFFERENT-OBJECT EXAMPLE · A quiet click under dialogue supports an action; a loud sustained crash can hide the words.

STRETCH · Create weight with a short low impact and a small debris tail rather than a louder peak.

Your checkpoint: predict → observe → revise

Prediction: _____

Observed result / frame: _____

Revision or next check: _____

06 · Use follow-through where the viewer looks

SELECT: An actually separate hand or prop inside Count_Performance after the proud accent; the seated body/head remains one baked image.

TOOLS / ROUTE: Pose keys; staggered finishes; short playback loop.

1. Choose the separate hand or a separate stone prop to finish slightly after the whole-body accent. Work inside Count_Performance at the existing cue frame numbers. Do not move the baked head independently of its torso. Keep its motion smaller than the main accent.

2. Inspect the final silhouette and the stones while the camera is closest. Remove small movements that compete with counting.

3. Preserve a clean ending hold long enough for the result to register.

WHY · Overlap adds life when the main action remains readable.

CHECK / SUMMARY · The eye is drawn to the intended main action and the recovery decreases into rest.

FIX · If the character appears rubbery, reduce the delay and amplitude. Do not animate every piece simply because it has a layer.

GLOSSARY · overlapping action: Related parts beginning or finishing at different times.; follow-through: Motion continuing after the main action ends.

DIFFERENT-OBJECT EXAMPLE · A coat hem can settle after a person stops, while the face remains the focus.

STRETCH · Use a stone wobble as the only secondary action after the final line.

Your checkpoint: predict → observe → revise

Prediction: _____

Observed result / frame: _____

Revision or next check: _____

07 · Repair an effect that hides the action

SELECT: A duplicate with an oversized effect or excessive camera zoom.

TOOLS / ROUTE: Effect scale/exposure; camera keys; before/after frames.

1. Create an obvious obstruction in the duplicate, such as a puff covering the first-contact pose.

2. Ask a viewer what happened at the landing. Repair the visual hierarchy by changing size, timing, layer order or framing.

3. Keep one before/after comparison and name the story information you recovered.

WHY · The repair evaluates effects by communication rather than spectacle.

CHECK / SUMMARY · The viewer can identify the contact and result after the repair.

FIX · If the effect still dominates, omit it temporarily and restore the essential pose first.

GLOSSARY · visual hierarchy: The order in which elements attract attention.

DIFFERENT-OBJECT EXAMPLE · An oversized title can hide the product it is meant to introduce; reducing it restores the purpose.

STRETCH · Keep the effect but reduce its contrast so the pose remains dominant.

Your checkpoint: predict → observe → revise

Prediction: _____

Observed result / frame: _____

Revision or next check: _____

08 · Direct a heavier landing

SELECT: Your independent landing/effect/sound version.

TOOLS / ROUTE: Pose keys; effect timing; sound cue; static camera comparison.

1. Keep the same jump distance. Revise the landing compression, recovery spacing and supporting effect/sound to imply greater weight.

2. Compare with the original under the same static camera first. Add a camera choice only if it helps read the action.

3. Save and reopen. Explain the cause of each effect and which change most altered the impression of weight.

WHY · The changed condition tests animation principles across pose, spacing and supporting media.

CHECK / SUMMARY · The heavier version remains readable and physically motivated, with clear speech later in the film.

FIX · If the difference depends only on louder sound, return to contact, compression and recovery.

GLOSSARY · weight cue: A visible or audible choice suggesting mass and force.

DIFFERENT-OBJECT EXAMPLE · Independent task: no heavy-landing solution is supplied.

STRETCH · Make a lighter landing as a third comparison without changing the character's size.

Your checkpoint: predict → observe → revise

Prediction: _____

Observed result / frame: _____

Revision or next check: _____

Keep a small, useful evidence record

At frame ___, I chose ___ so the viewer could ___.
The problem was caused by ___. I changed ___ and checked ___.
Under the changed condition, I revised ___ because ___.

One repair

One independent decision and its trade-off

Delivery check

The selected file reopens. The result plays as intended. Joints/contact and audio were checked where relevant. The changed condition is solved. Required production files and a brief defence are retained.

Method references and attribution

A1 · Adobe Animate: symbols and instances · Adobe reference

A2 · Adobe Animate: timeline layers · Adobe reference

A3 · Adobe Animate: shape tweening · Adobe reference

A4 · Adobe Animate: parenting view · Adobe reference

A5 · Adobe Animate: sound · Adobe reference

A6 · Adobe Animate: camera · Adobe reference

Original teacher-supplied Caveman PDF/PNG assets are preserved. New matching Caveman parts/backgrounds are AI-generated and identified in the asset register. Teaching diagrams are authored illustrations; genuine native captures are labelled separately. Supplied commercial course videos/FLAs are reference material and are not redistributed.

Publication/classroom status: see the teacher companion. This file does not certify the independent cold run, a natural voice performance, or live assessment/progress connections.